

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1998-09-29

1 disturbing news about the friends in i ran.

2 Sentences of death have been communicated orally by prison authorities

in mashhad to messrs. Sirus zabihi-m oghaddam and hedayat-kashefi Na-

3 jafabadi, two of the three bahá'ís who were imprisoned and tried along with

4 the recently executed mr. ruhollah rohani, according to reports received at

5 the bahá'í world center. The third bahá'í, mr. Ataollah hamid Nasiriza-

6 deh, was condemned to 10 years' imprisonment and will be transferred to a

7 prison in k erman.

you may well recall that when a number of governments protested to

8 the iranian government regarding the execution on 21 july 1998 of mr.

9 rohani, they also appealed for the safety of the other bahá'í prisoners in

10 mashhad, and officials of some of these governments were given to under-

11 stand from statements of iranian officials that the iranian authorities would

12 not carry out any further executions.

13 . . . in his [mr. rohani's] case there was at first an official denial of his

14 execution, and then, when it was confirmed otherwise and the iranian gov-

15 ernment found itself confronted by worldwide protest, it excused its action by making the spurious accusation that he had acted against the security of the country. The rationale was that the nature of the case made it impossible

16 for details to be revealed. in the current situation, no such chicanery on the

17 part of iranian authorities should be countenanced. The surreptitious man-

ner in which the sentence of death was conveyed to messrs. moghaddam

18 and Najafabadi by word of mouth, without any evident documentation,

19 raises serious questions as to how the authorities intend to deal with inter-national reactions. . . .

Department of tHe secretariat285.1

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Details on Bahá'ís Imprisoned and

Sentenced to Death in Iran

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]